

Shepherd's Pie (Variation 10)

Tags: lamb, beef, dinner, british, comfort-food, winter | Prep: 30 min | Cook: 60 min | Serves: 8

Ingredients

- filling: 2.7 tbsp olive oil, 1 onion diced, 2 carrots diced, 2 celery stalks diced, 4 garlic cloves, 700 g minced lamb (or beef for cottage pie), 2 tbsp tomato paste, 250 ml red wine, 400 ml lamb/beef stock, 1 can (400 g) crushed tomatoes, 1 tbsp worcestershire sauce, 2 sprigs rosemary, 1 cup frozen peas
- Topping: 1.6 kg floury potatoes, 80 g butter, 100 ml hot milk, 80 g mature cheddar grated, salt and white pepper

Method

1. Heat oil in a large ovenproof skillet. Cook onion, carrots, and celery for 8 minutes. Add garlic for 1 minute.
2. Increase heat, add mince and cook until well-browned, breaking up lumps.
3. Add tomato paste, cook 2 minutes. Add wine and reduce for 3 minutes.
4. Add stock, tomatoes, Worcestershire, and rosemary. Simmer uncovered for 30 minutes until thick. Stir in peas.
5. For topping: Boil potatoes until tender. Drain and steam-dry for 5 minutes. Mash with butter and hot milk. Season with salt and white pepper.
6. Preheat oven to 200 °C. Spoon potato topping over the filling and spread evenly. Fork the surface to create texture.
7. Scatter with grated cheddar. Bake for 25–30 minutes until golden and bubbling.
8. Rest 10 minutes before serving.

Chef Tips

- A stiff mash works better as a topping than a loose one — reduce the milk if needed.
- Creating ridges on the potato top with a fork creates more surface area for browning.
- Assemble and refrigerate a day ahead, then bake from cold adding 15 extra minutes.